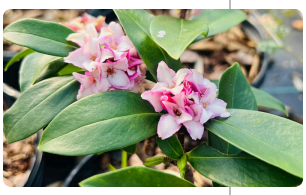
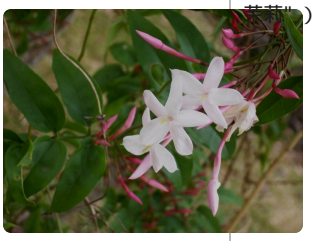
Berkeley 香花名录 · Fragrant Flower Reference for Berkeley, CA

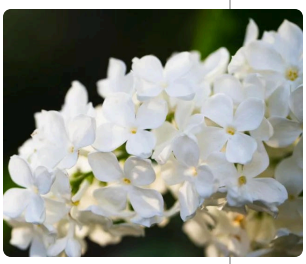
22 scented plants with bilingual (Chinese–English) names. Sorted by **bloom start (December → September)** for easy year-round reference.

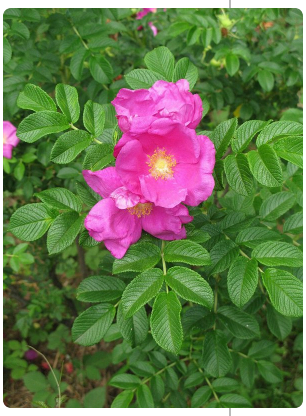
- **Climate background**: Central Berkeley flats (near University Ave / Trader Joe's; not the Berkeley Hills) ≈ USDA 10a on the 2023 map, with 10b pockets nearby; the 2012 map showed 10a here. Warm-summer Mediterranean (Köppen Csb) with strong marine influence: cooler, foggier summers than the hills (frequent afternoon marine layer that can persist into evening), mild winters, rare frost, ~22–25" annual rain.
- **Scent rating**: ★–★★★★★ (intensity detectable at arm's length; generally reduced on foggy days).

English name	Chinese name	Berkeley cultivation notes	Scent notes	Bloom period (scent months)	Asian cultural notes
Wintersweet (Chimonanthus praecox) 	蜡梅	Easy to grow: full sun to partial shade, excellent drainage (does not tolerate standing water around the roots), drought-tolerant once established; yellow-flowered types are far more fragrant than white-flowered ones[1]	★★★★ Cold fragrance that intensifies as temperatures drop; the yellow types ('Aureus'/'苏雨仙' lineage) are intense, white-flowered types are very faint	Dec–Feb	The twelfth-month (腊月) flower deity of the traditional "Flower Calendar" (花历); long prized in Chinese literati culture for its "cold fragrance" (冷香) as a symbol of lofty, unworldly character; sometimes grouped with other fragrant classics, though the standard "Four Gentlemen" (花中四君子) are plum, orchid, bamboo and chrysanthemum
Wallflower (Cheiranthus cheiri, now Erysimum × cheiri) 	桂竹香[2]	Easy to grow: cool-season crop, grown as a biennial (short-lived perennial); full sun, does not tolerate standing water (well-drained soil); frequent deadheading prolongs the bloom	★★★★ Spicy-sweet Brassicaceae scent - the old-fashioned "wall scent" (hence the English name wallflower)	Dec–Mar	In the Chinese tradition, in fine gardens by the Tang dynasty (recorded in ancient materia medica (《本草》) texts and in Tang poetry) - on that lineage, one of the oldest winter-fragrance flowers in the Chinese garden context
White Champaca (Magnolia × alba) 	白兰	Tender subtropical hybrid: cold-sensitive and prefers warmer, more protected microclimates. In the cooler, foggier central Berkeley flats, in-ground flowering is unreliable and pot + winter protection is safer; established trees do flower well in warmer Bay Area spots (e.g. Berkeley Hills, SF Botanical Garden, Stanford)	★★★★★ The reference scent of the street flower vendors and yulan tea; most intense in the cool morning	Dec–Mar (Bay Area); multiple flushes in warm regions	Core of Lingnan (South China) and old-Shanghai folk custom: flowers pinned in the hair, street flower carriers (花婆, "flower aunties"), yulan (白兰) tea; the Cantonese name "pak lan" is the Cantonese reading of 白兰, and the flower is a staple of Lingnan nostalgia imagery (the classic song 白兰花, literature); close relative Yellow Champaca (黃緬 桂) (yellow champaca, *Magnolia champaca*) is an offering flower in South Asian Hindu and Buddhist worship

English name	Chinese name	Berkeley cultivation notes	Scent notes	Bloom period (scent months)	Asian cultural notes
Banana Shrub (Michelia figo, syn. Magnolia figo) 	含笑	Extremely easy: cold- and drought-tolerant, full sun to partial shade, almost maintenance-free	★★★–★★★★ Banana-sweet fragrance, strongest in the morning and when cool	Primarily spring (Apr–Jun), with possible extension into summer/fall in mild Bay Area climates	"Manjushri's smile" from the Vimalakirti Sutra; the idiom "smile in the netherworld" derives from the flower; common subject in literati painting
Winter Daphne (Daphne odora) 	瑞香	Very easy to grow (the least demanding of the *Daphne* genus): drainage is a matter of life and death (does not tolerate standing water around the roots), summer-dry, full sun to partial shade; performs even better in the Bay Area than in the East	★★★★★ One of the most intense woody-plant scents of winter and spring	Jan–Mar (earlier in the Bay Area than in the East)	the name 瑞香 means "fragrance of auspicious omen" (花中祥瑞 "auspicious omen among flowers"); *Daphne* is planted in the 紫竹林 (Purple Bamboo Grove) on Mt. Putuo, a Guanyin/Avalokiteshvara pilgrimage site
Paperwhite Narcissus (Narcissus papyraceus / tazetta group) 	洋水仙（纸白型）[3]	Primarily an indoor forcing bulb: set on pebbles/rocks with water just touching the base, blooms in 4–6 weeks; discard after bloom (standard practice). Can also be planted outdoors in fall in mild Bay Area gardens where it may naturalize, but the classic use is the temporary indoor display	★★★★ Strong fragrance typical of the tazetta group (most other narcissus are scentless or weakly scented)	Feb–Mar	No traditional Asian cultural background for this Western tazetta form; the classic Chinese New Year narcissus is N. tazetta var. chinensis — do not confuse the two
Hyacinth（Hyacinthus orientalis） 	风信子	Primarily an indoor forcing bulb (pre-chilled or chilled, then bloomed in soil or water; often discarded after). Can also be planted outdoors in fall (15 cm deep, good drainage, dry summer dormancy) and may persist as a garden bulb in mild Bay Area conditions, but the classic use is temporary indoor forcing	★★★★★ 早春气味天花板；室内一瓶满屋	2–4 月	中东/地中海系，亚洲无传统；靠气味本身进入现代亚洲生活（切花/室内香）

English name	Chinese name	Berkeley cultivation notes	Scent notes	Bloom period (scent months)	Asian cultural notes
'Brandywine' Crabapple（ Malus 'Branzam' / Brandywine ® ） 	海棠（'Brandywine'）[4]	好种：小乔木，全日照，幼树给水，成熟耐旱；注意痂病（中等抗性）与锈病（较 差）	★★★★ 重瓣玫瑰粉色花，浓香；果实偏苦	3–4 月（花）	海棠是经典" 海棠四品"（贴梗/垂丝/西府/日本）的春天象征；'Brandywine' 是 1970s–80s Simpson Nursery 培育的重瓣粉色开花海棠，果实较大（约 1" ）但偏 苦/单宁高，无亚洲渊源。名字与著名的 Brandywine 番茄无关
Mexican Orange Blossom（ Choisya ternata ） 	三叶橙花	极好种：加州/墨西哥原生，零维护，耐旱，全日照至半阴	★★★ 橙花（ neroli 型）香，中等	3–4 月（偶有秋末返花）	北美原生，亚洲文化无背景；因闻起来像橙花而被亚洲园圃接纳
Pink Jasmine（ Jasminum polyanthum ） 	多花素馨（花市称" 粉茉莉/多花茉莉"）[5]	极好种：强健常绿藤，爱地中海气候，全日照，成型后耐旱；需要攀爬物	★★★★★" 茉莉族" 里最香；粉色花苞开白，夏夜尤烈	3–10 月（春最盛）	原产中国西南（滇黔），与茉莉花茶所用的 J. multiflorum 同属近缘；本身无深 度文化典故
Chinese Wisteria（ Wisteria sinensis ） 	紫藤	能种：日紫藤更香但雾区长不好，两难之下选本种；植株巨大，要钢架级支撑；幼 树给水，成型耐旱；沿海有逸生记录，别放篱边	★★★ 淡甜香，远弱于日紫藤（ W. floribunda ）	4–5 月（先花后叶或同步）	唐宋以来诗词书画常客；日本有藤花祭（ fuji ）；韩国视紫藤为长寿/婚姻美满 的象征

English name	Chinese name	Berkeley cultivation notes	Scent notes	Bloom period (scent months)	Asian cultural notes
Perfumed Currant（Ribes odoratum ）  	香醋栗（香水醋栗）	可种：北美中部原生（明尼苏达至德克萨斯一带，非太平洋沿岸），喜凉，全日照 至半阴，成型后耐旱。 Note: this white-flowered eastern form is a cold-climate shrub (USDA 3–4) and is one of the harder plants in the table for the Bay Area — it survives Berkeley winters but needs consistent moisture and summer protection from dry heat/fog-free heat (a pot, a cool moist corner, or summer irrigation); the yellow-flowered California-native *R. aureum* (var. *gracillimum*) is the form that thrives here if scent can be traded for reliability.	★★★★★ 茉莉+橙花/丁香型花香，浆果灌木里很香	5–6 月	北美中部原生，亚洲文化无背景；对亚洲园圃是" 新移民"
Lilac, white（Syringa vulgaris 白花系；海岸更稳：Syringa reticulata 香花丁香） 	白丁香[6]	中等： S. vulgaris 在湾区能活但偏水土不服（它爱更湿更凉的东部气候）——全 日照+排水+夏补一点水；图省心选 S. reticulata ，耐旱耐雾	★★★★ 白花品种通常比紫花更冲	5–6 月	" 丁香结" ——花苞未展如结，李商隐" 芭蕉不展丁香结" ，中国诗词里幽郁愁思的 经典意象（多指紫丁香）；日本视丁香为早春报春花
Gardenia（Gardenia jasminoides ） 	栀子花	好种名单里最难：酸性土（pH<6 ）、持续湿润、补铁、防霜；雾带反给一点 湿度；最稳方案是盆栽+冬季挪入	★★★★★ 白花朵朵满屋，单支即可充满一个房间	5–9 月（湾区盛于夏末）	" 花中四雅" 之一；果实是传统天然黄染料（栀子黄）与中药；流行文化里《栀子 花开》= 青春/夏日符号；日本" くちなし" 偏哀愁意象（墓地植栽传统）
Cleveland Sage（Salvia clevelandii ） 	克利夫兰鼠尾草	极好种：加州原生，全日照，旱到不用管	★★★★ 风一过整丛出香，揉叶香气很冲	5–9 月（湾区含秋末返花）	加州原生，无亚洲背景；可视为西方版" 芳香鼠尾草" ，功能位同亚洲的藿香/紫 苏

English name	Chinese name	Berkeley cultivation notes	Scent notes	Bloom period (scent months)	Asian cultural notes
California Mock Orange（ Philadelphus lewisii ） 	山梅花（刘易斯山梅花）	好种：太平洋西北原生，耐寒健壮，全日照，夏适量给水	★★★★ 花季" 橙花/mock orange" 浓香	5–6 月	种名无亚洲背景；" 山梅花" 是 Philadelphus 属的中文正名，容易让人误以为有 中式渊源
Damask Rose（ Rosa × damascena ） 	大马士革玫瑰（大马士革蔷薇、突厥蔷薇）	中难：雾带里挑**最晒、最干、排水最好**的位置；凉湿春秋防霜 霉/白粉；雾会明显削弱出香 [7]	★★★★★ 玫瑰香基准（ rose otto/纯露都出自它）；雾区夏凉会打折	5–6 月（单季）	伊朗国花，沙特 Taif 玫瑰蒸馏技艺入联合国非遗；印度 gulab（玫瑰水/酱）的 信仰与饮食基底；中国玫瑰饼/玫瑰月饼/玫瑰露酒传统
Rugosa Rose（ Rosa rugosa ，含平阴玫瑰 R. rugosa var. platyphylla ） 	突瓣蔷薇/海滨蔷薇（平阴玫瑰系）[8]	极好种：东亚海岸沙滩玫瑰，在加州海岸已归化；耐旱耐盐耐风，建植后不浇；根 茎蔓延，控好边界	★★★ 中等（平阴宽叶型更香、更偏食用）；远弱于大马士革	6–8 月（可复花）	平阴玫瑰（山东）是中国经典食用玫瑰：玫瑰酱/玫瑰饼/玫瑰露； rugosa 系是中 国食用玫瑰的主力血统
Lavender（ Lavandula angustifolia ，'Hidcote'/'Sentia'/'Dunvegan' ） 	薰衣草	好种：真薰衣草完全适应湾区；全日照+排水极好的干地，成型后断水；雾区偏凉 没问题，忌积水	★★★★★ 全株四季常香，花季最烈	6–8 月（品种错开）	西方浪漫/普罗旺斯符号，亚洲无传统背景；随切花与香薰进入现代生活

English name	Chinese name	Berkeley cultivation notes	Scent notes	Bloom period (scent months)	Asian cultural notes
Star Jasmine（Trachelospermum jasminoides） 	络石（花市称" 风车茉莉" ，实非茉莉属）	极好种：常绿藤，需要攀爬物，成型后耐旱，全日照至半阴	★★★★ 茉莉型浓香，傍晚最明显；湾区冬季可返花返香	7–9 月（湾区偶有冬季返花）	络石藤是中国传统中药（祛风通络）；" 风车茉莉" 是纯商业名，本种无花文化典 故
Flowering Tobacco（Nicotiana alata） 	花烟草	极好种：夏播一年生，常自播成苗；喜热喜阳耐旱；全表唯一" 夜间香" 主力	★★★★★ 日落后开到浓烈，夏季花园的嗅觉天花板	7 月–霜降（香味集中在夜）	新世界植物（烟草属北美/南美原产），亚洲无传统
Sweet Osmanthus (Osmanthus fragrans) 	桂花	Grows well but at a discount: hardy and thrives in the Bay Area, but the heavy fog and not-hot-enough summers mean fewer flowers and a blunted scent; plant in the sunniest, warmest corner possible; repeat-flowering types (佛顶珠 Fodingzhu / 四季桂 Sijigui) bloom more reliably here than 金桂 Jingu ì[7]	★★★★★ The benchmark of autumn scent (still the strongest autumn fragrance in the fog belt, discount applied)	Sept–Oct (Bay Area; Sept–Nov farther east or inland)	#1 in the table for cultural weight: the flower most tied to the Mid-Autumn Festival (桂花月饼 osmanthus mooncakes); 折桂 “picking osmanthus in the moon palace” = the millennial metaphor for passing the imperial exams (科举及第); osmanthus wine/cakes/tea; written through by Li Bai (李白), Lu You (陆游) and poets of every age since; in Japan one of the three great aromatic trees (三大香木), with daphne and gardenia; the same autumn/moon lineage on the Korean Peninsula (Chuseok □□)

脚注 · Footnotes

[1] **Wintersweet — plant the yellow-flowered types**: white-flowered chimonanthus is generally faint; for real scent, grow the yellow-green-flowered types ('Aureus', 'Aureospiculata' / 苏雨仙 "Su Yuxian").

[2] **Wallflower 桂竹香** is the standard Chinese name for *Cheiranthus cheiri* (Brassicaceae, genus *Cheiranthus*) — unrelated to osmanthus 桂花 or bamboo 竹; the name is just an inherited old term. The English plant name cheiranth (from the genus name) likewise shares the same Greek root.

[3] **Paperwhite vs Chinese narcissus**: paperwhite belongs to the Western *tazetta* hybrid line; the traditional Chinese New Year flower is the Chinese narcissus (*N. tazetta* var. *chinensis*). Same genus, entirely different cultural systems.

[4] **海棠 "haitang" vs 'Brandywine'**: 海棠 in Chinese is a broad cultural term covering flowering crabapples/quince (贴梗 / 垂丝 / 西府 / 日本海棠); 'Brandywine' (botanical name *Malus* 'Branzam') is a double-petaled pink-flowering crabapple bred by Simpson Nursery in Indiana in the 1970s–80s, fruit ~1 inch, rather bitter. The name is a common place name, unrelated to the famous 19th-century Brandywine tomato (named for Brandywine Creek on the PA/DE border), and no kin to Chinese 海棠.

[5] **多花素馨 is not "true jasmine"**: jasmine tea is made mainly from *Jasminum sambac* (Arabian jasmine / 虎丘茉莉 Huqiu jasmine); *J. polyanthum* is a hardy vine native to southwestern China, sold as "粉茉莉/云南茉莉" (pink jasmine / Yunnan jasmine),

with a stronger, more assertive scent.

[6] **The name "白丁香" (white lilac) is ambiguous**: Chinese "白丁香" usually means white-flowered cultivars of common lilac (*S. vulgaris*); but on the coast / in the Bay Area, the fragrant lilac *S. reticulata* (white, drought- and fog-tolerant) is the more dependable choice. Buy by botanical name: *S. vulgaris* = moderate difficulty, *S. reticulata* = easy.

[7] **The fog-belt penalty clause**: "dry-heat heavy-scent" plants like Damask rose and sweet osmanthus 桂花 all get their scent discounted in Berkeley's fog — this is not a growing-practice issue, it is a climate ceiling. For full-strength scent, choose inland hot valley floors (inland East Bay south of Oakland's east side, the Foothills) or accept pot culture.

[8] **The 平阴玫瑰 (Pingyin rose) line**: commercial "平阴玫瑰" = the broad-leaved variety of *Rosa rugosa* (var. *platyphylla*), the workhorse of northern China's edible roses (rose jam 玫瑰酱 / rose cakes 玫瑰饼); in the Bay Area grow it like an ordinary *R. rugosa* — its scent is pleasant but far weaker than Damask rose (the reference standard for rose perfumes and edible roses), matching the row's ★★★ rating.

Image credits

Flower photos resized from Wikimedia Commons (CC BY-SA / public domain) or open web sources. Full attribution and licenses are on the original Commons file pages.

- Wintersweet: *File:Chimonanthus praecox, Morris Arboretum 02.jpg* (Shuvaev, CC.
- Wallflower: *File:Erysimum cheiri gold garden flowers.jpg* (Jina Lee, CC BY-SA)
- White Champaca: *File:White champak flower.jpg* (SKsiddhartthan)
- Banana Shrub: *File:Michelia figo flower.JPG* (Midori, CC BY-SA)
- Winter Daphne: open web (Daphne odora in bloom)
- Paperwhite: *File:Narcissus papyraceus 'Paper-White Narcissus' (Amaryllidaceae) flowers HDR.jpg* (Magnus Manske)
- Hyacinth: open web (Hyacinthus orientalis in bloom)
- 'Brandywine' Crabapple: general double pink Malus blossom (proxy; specific cultivar photo scarce)
- Mexican Orange: *File:Choisya Inflorescence FR 2013.jpg* (JLPC, CC BY-SA)
- Pink Jasmine: *File:Jasminum polyanthum flowers.JPG* (B.navez)
- Chinese Wisteria: open web (Wisteria sinensis)
- Perfumed Currant: Dave's Garden member photo (re-hosted via Pinterest), cream/white-flowered form of clove currant. Note: standard botanical descriptions (FNA, MOBOT, RHS) list flowers as yellow; this photo is used per preference for the white/cream form. *R. odoratum* = *R. aureum* var. villosum.
- Lilac (white): open web (Syringa vulgaris white form)
- Gardenia: *File:Gardenia jasminoides flower.jpg* (Md Arif bd)
- Cleveland Sage: open web (Salvia clevelandii in bloom, lavender spikes)
- California Mock Orange: *File:Philadelphus lewisii (7283693140).jpg*
- Damask Rose: open web (Rosa × damascena)
- Rugosa Rose: open web (Rosa rugosa)
- Lavender: open web (Lavandula angustifolia)
- Star Jasmine: open web (Trachelospermum jasminoides)
- Flowering Tobacco: open web (Nicotiana alata)
- Sweet Osmanthus: open web (Osmanthus fragrans)